

JAHANGIRNAGAR UNIVERSITY

DEPARTMENT OF ENGLISH

BA (HONOURS) 4TH YEAR FINAL EXAMINATION QUESTION BANK

COURSE CODE: E 412

COURSE TITLE: Psycholinguistics

Target Stream: Concentration on Applied Linguistics & ELT

Batches Included: 42, 43, 44, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50 (Batch 45 missing)

CURRENT SYLLABUS REFERENCE & SCOPE (Session: 2021–2022, Batch 51)

SYLLABUS TOPICS:

- **Foundations:** Definition, history, development, scopes, and multidisciplinary branches of Psycholinguistics.
- **Child Language Acquisition (L1):** Developmental stages (pre-linguistic, babbling, sensori-motor, holophrastic / one-word, two-word, telegraphic); Characteristics of child grammar.
- **L1 Acquisition Theories:** Behaviourist theory (Skinner, conditioning); Mentalist / Innatist theory (Chomsky, LAD, UG); Biological theory & Critical Period Hypothesis (Lenneberg); Cognitive theory (Piaget, cognitive pre-requisites); Social Interactionist theory (Vygotsky, Bruner, LASS, motherese/parentese).
- **Second Language Acquisition (SLA / L2) Theories:** Krashen's Monitor Model (Acquisition-Learning, Natural Order, Monitor, Input, Affective Filter); Interlanguage theory (Selinker, Tarone, Adjemian); Linguistic universals; Schumann's Acculturation Model (social & psychological distance); Cognitive information-processing models.
- **Individual Learner Factors:** Age & Critical Period; Language aptitude; Motivation (integrative vs. instrumental); Attitude; Personality (extroversion, anxiety); Cognitive styles & working memory; Fossilization.
- **Neurolinguistics & Language Pathology:** Hemispheric lateralization; Broca's and Wernicke's areas; Aphasia (Broca's, Wernicke's, conduction); Dyslexia; Language deprivation (Victor, Genie); Language therapy.

SECTION A: BROAD ESSAY QUESTIONS

Comprehensive essay questions from past examinations, organized according to key theoretical areas.

1. Scope of Psycholinguistics & Neurolinguistics

1. What is psycholinguistics? Give an account of the development, scope, and significance of psycholinguistics as an interdisciplinary field of study. [50, 49, 47, 46, 43, 42]
2. Discuss the relationship between the brain and language. Write on aphasia, its types (Broca's, Wernicke's), causes, and prominent features. Provide clinical and linguistic examples. [50, 42]
3. What role does the human brain play in the language acquisition process? Briefly discuss the lateralization of functions in the human brain. [43, 42]

2. Child Language Acquisition Stages & L1 Theories

1. What is language acquisition? Discuss the different stages of a child's L1 acquisition from birth to the age of 30 months (cooing, babbling, holophrastic, two-word, telegraphic). [49, 48, 47, 44, 43, 42]
2. Explain the Nativist / Innatist Theory of 1st language acquisition. Point out the strengths and weaknesses of the theory with reference to Chomsky's LAD and Universal Grammar. [50, 48, 46, 44, 43, 42]
3. What is the behaviourist notion of language acquisition? Substantiate behaviourism as a theoretical approach that facilitates language acquisition with reference to a particular teaching method (e.g., Audio-Lingual Method) built around it. [49, 48, 47, 46, 44, 43, 42]
4. How does the traditional nature-nurture debate relate to the study of language acquisition? Contrast the behaviourist and mentalist positions. [49, 48, 44]
5. Discuss biological theory with its limitations. What evidence supports the biological basis of language? [47]
6. Discuss Piaget's theory of cognitive development in the light of his contention that "development precedes learning." [42]

7. What is motherese (child-directed speech)? Discuss the characteristics of motherese and point out its effects on early language development. [49]

3. Second Language Acquisition (SLA) Theories

1. Expound the basic propositions of Krashen's Monitor Model Theory (the 5 hypotheses). Evaluate its merits, methodological flaws, and relevance as a second language learning theory. [50, 49, 48, 47, 46, 44, 43, 42]
2. What is Interlanguage? What are its major characteristics? Discuss the causes, stages, and processes of Interlanguage development (Selinker, Tarone, Adjemian). [50, 49, 48, 46, 44, 43, 42]
3. Evaluate the strengths and weaknesses of Schumann's Acculturation Model in explaining L2 learning. How does social and psychological distance affect SLA? [50, 47, 46, 44, 43]
4. What is Universal Grammar? How would you explain the relationship between UG and second language acquisition? [46, 44]
5. Reflect on your own second language learning experience (English), critically evaluating it using some of the SLA theories that you have studied. [43]

4. Age Factor, Individual Differences & Fossilization

1. With reference to different cases of language deprivation (Victor of Aveyron, Genie) and adult learners, present a critical analysis of Lenneberg's Critical Period Hypothesis (CPH). [50, 49, 48, 46]
2. Name the different individual factors that cause variation among learners in second language learning (aptitude, attitude, motivation, cognitive styles, personality). Discuss their roles in detail. [50, 48, 46, 44, 42]
3. Define fossilization. Identify the aspects and causes of fossilization, and discuss how fossilization in an L2 learner's interlanguage continuum challenges linguistic development. [49]

SECTION B: SHORT NOTES & PSYCHOLINGUISTIC CONCEPTS

Short notes and definitions covering experimental, psychological, and neurological concepts.

Short Notes Collection

1. Acquired dyslexia and its features [50]
2. Different stages of L1 acquisition [50]
3. Classical conditioning vs. Operant conditioning [50, 47]
4. Social Interactionist Theory of language acquisition (Vygotsky / Bruner) [50, 49, 48]
5. Interlanguage and its characteristics [49]
6. The relation between language and brain [49]
7. The innatist theory of language acquisition [49]
8. Nature versus nurture debate in language learning [48, 43]
9. Fossilization [48, 42]
10. Parentese / Motherese [48, 42]
11. Motivation (Integrative vs. Instrumental) [47]
12. Competence and Performance (Chomsky) [47, 42]
13. Language Acquisition Device (LAD) [47, 42]
14. Formal operational stage (Piaget) [47]

- 15. Victor and Genie (Feral children and CPH) [46]
- 16. Affective Filter Hypothesis [46]
- 17. Babbling stage [46]
- 18. Working memory in SLA [46]
- 19. Critical Period Hypothesis [46]
- 20. Cognitive styles (Field dependent vs. independent) [43]
- 21. Lateralization of functions in human brain [43]
- 22. Core grammar and peripheral grammar [44]
- 23. Language aptitude [44]
- 24. Broca's aphasia [42]
- 25. Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD; Vygotsky) [42]
- 26. Pivot Grammar (Braine) [42]
- 27. CALP (Cognitive Academic Language Proficiency vs. BICS) [42]